

Sultant Of Oman
Ministry of Health
Royal Hospital



سلطنة عمان
وزارة الصحة
المستشفى السلطاني

Document Management System



Sultanate of Oman
Ministry of Health
The Royal Hospital
Department of Pharmacy

Code: PH-POL-1-Vers.1.1

Effective Date: 01/07/2024

Target Review Date: 01/07/2028

Title: Antibiotic IV to Oral switch criteria

Introduction:

Intravenous(IV) administration of antibiotics can be life saving for critically ill patients. However oral (PO) absorption of antibiotics is near normal in all except the critically ill. Therefore, even in sick hospitalized patients POantibiotic administration is preferred due to decreasing drug cost, decreasing length of stay and decreasing/ eliminating IV-line Phlebitis and sepsis.Furthermore, switching IV to PO in as an antibiotic stewardship intervention that aims to optimize the use of antibiotics.

Choosing the appropriate route of administration is governed by many factors such as; the availability of oral formulations and patient condition. Therefore, converting from IV to PO antibiotics must be considered if the patient fits the criteria listed in the policy. ⁽¹⁾

Purpose:

This policy provides a guide for healthcare professionals to switch IV to PO antibiotics whenever feasible.

Scope:

This policy applies to all patients admitted in the Royal Hospital. It should be applied by all staff working at the hospital.

The criteria of IV to PO antibiotics must be followed once the patient fits the criteria and should be totally based on the clinical judgment of the treating team.

Criteria for switching antibiotics from IV toPO:

- Patient is not spiking fever for 48 hours
- Patient is hemodynamically stable
- Patient inflammatory markers improved to normal
- No sign of sepsis
- Availability of an oral alternative
- No essential requirement for IV antibiotic such as high tissue concentration
- Not applicable for patients <1 months
- List of conditions in which IV treatment is required ie, endocarditis, Staph bacteraemia, osteomyelitis, etc (1,2)

References

Title of book/ journal/ articles/ Website	Author	Year of publication	Page	Reviewed & updated by: Ph. Zaher Al Salmi, 2024
1. Antibiotics: IV to Oral Southern Health Pharmacy Department Australia	Antimicrobial Stewardship Committee Southern Health	Feb 2012		
2. Medications Monitoring: Intravenous to Oral Therapeutic Interchange Program Sanford Hospital and Clinics Pharmacy Department Policies and Procedures	Sanford Hospital and Clinics	Feb 2013	1-2	

Written By: Ph Abdullah Al-Ajmi

Checked By: Ph. Zaher Alsalmi Ph Asma Alhindi

Authorized by: FAISAL AL-HARTHI

[Back](#)


© Copyright 2018 reserved 'Royal Hospital-
Information Technology Department'